

Pros and Cons of Practicing Mindfulness

Due Date: _____ Name: _____ Week Starting: _____

Make a list of the pros and cons of practicing mindfulness skills.

Make another list of the pros and cons of *not* practicing mindfulness skills.

Check the facts to be sure that you are correct in your assessment of advantages and disadvantages.

Rate Willingness to Practice (0 = None; 100 = Very High) **Before:** _____ **After:** _____

Fill this worksheet out when you are:

- Trying to decide whether to work on becoming more mindful of the moments in your life.
- Feeling willful; saying no to letting go of emotion mind or extreme reasonable mind.
- Resisting observing the present moment, rather than escaping it or trying to control it.
- Resisting giving up your interpretations of others or yourself, rather than just describing.
- Resisting throwing yourself into the flow of the moment; wanting to stand on the outside.
- Feeling threatened whenever you think of letting go of judgments.
- Not in the mood for being effective instead of proving you are right.

When you are filling out this worksheet, think about these questions:

- Is a mindless life in your best interest (i.e., effective), or not in your best interest (i.e., ineffective)?
- Will refusing to go into Wise Mind solve a problem, or make a new problem for you?
- Is observing the moment without reacting to it immediately likely to increase your freedom, or decrease it?
- Is being attached to your thoughts instead of the facts you can describe useful, or not?
- Is staying judgmental helping you change the things you want to change, or getting in the way?
- Is it more important to be effective, or to be right?

PROS	Stay Mindless, Judgmental, Ineffective	Practice Mindfulness
	_____	_____
	_____	_____
	_____	_____
	_____	_____
CONS	Stay Mindless, Judgmental, Ineffective	Practice Mindfulness
	_____	_____
	_____	_____
	_____	_____
	_____	_____

What did you decide to do? _____**Is this the best decision (in Wise Mind)?** _____**List any and all wise things you did this week.** _____

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Mindfulness Core Skills Practice

Due Date: _____ Name: _____ Week Starting: _____

Describe the situations that prompted you to practice mindfulness.

SITUATION 1

Situation (who, what, when, where):

- ☐ Wise Mind
- ☐ Observe
- ☐ Describe
- ☐ Participate
- ☐ Nonjudgmentally
- ☐ One-mindfully
- ☐ Effectively

At left, check the skills you used, and describe your use of them here.

Describe experience of using the skill:

Check if practicing this mindfulness skill has influenced any of the following, *even a little bit*:

- | | | |
|---|---|---|
| ☐ Reduced suffering | ☐ Increased happiness | ☐ Increased ability to focus |
| ☐ Decreased reactivity | ☐ Increased wisdom | ☐ Increased experiencing the |
| ☐ Increased connection | ☐ Increased sense of personal validity | present |

SITUATION 2

Situation (who, what, when, where):

- ☐ Wise Mind
- ☐ Observe
- ☐ Describe
- ☐ Participate
- ☐ Nonjudgmentally
- ☐ One-mindfully
- ☐ Effectively

At left, check the skills you used, and describe your use of them here.

Describe experience of using the skill:

Check if practicing this mindfulness skill has influenced any of the following, *even a little bit*:

- | | | |
|---|---|---|
| ☐ Reduced suffering | ☐ Increased happiness | ☐ Increased ability to focus |
| ☐ Decreased reactivity | ☐ Increased wisdom | ☐ Increased experiencing the |
| ☐ Increased connection | ☐ Increased sense of personal validity | present |

List any and all wise things you did this week. _____

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Mindfulness Core Skills Practice

Due Date: _____ Name: _____ Week Starting: _____

For each mindfulness skill, write down what you did during the week, and then rate the quality of mindfulness you experienced during your practice.

*I could not focus my mind
for even 1 second; I was
completely mindless and quit.*

1

*I was able to focus my
mind somewhat and stay
in the present moment.*

3

*I became centered in Wise
Mind and was free to let go
and do what was needed.*

5**Day****Wise Mind**

_____ / _____	Mindfulness: _____
_____ / _____	Mindfulness: _____
_____ / _____	Mindfulness: _____

Day:**Observe**

_____ / _____	Mindfulness: _____
_____ / _____	Mindfulness: _____
_____ / _____	Mindfulness: _____

Day:**Describe**

_____ / _____	Mindfulness: _____
_____ / _____	Mindfulness: _____
_____ / _____	Mindfulness: _____

Day:**Participate**

_____ / _____	Mindfulness: _____
_____ / _____	Mindfulness: _____
_____ / _____	Mindfulness: _____

Day:**Nonjudgmentally**

_____ / _____	Mindfulness: _____
_____ / _____	Mindfulness: _____
_____ / _____	Mindfulness: _____

Day:**One-mindfully**

_____ / _____	Mindfulness: _____
_____ / _____	Mindfulness: _____
_____ / _____	Mindfulness: _____

Day:**Effectively**

_____ / _____	Mindfulness: _____
_____ / _____	Mindfulness: _____
_____ / _____	Mindfulness: _____

List any and all wise things you did this week. _____

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MINDFULNESS WORKSHEET 2B (Mindfulness Handouts 2–5c)

Mindfulness Core Skills Practice

Due Date: _____ Name: _____ Week Starting: _____

Practice each mindfulness skill twice, and describe your experience as follows:

When did you practice this skill, and what did you do to practice?	What was going on that prompted practicing mindfulness (if anything)?	How much time passed when you were doing this skill?	Rate before/after skill use		Conclusions or questions about this skills practice
			Degree of focusing my mind (0–100)	Degree of being centered in Wise Mind (0–100)	
Wise Mind:			/	/	
			/	/	
Observe:			/	/	
			/	/	
Describe:			/	/	
			/	/	
Participate:			/	/	
			/	/	
Nonjudgmentally:			/	/	
			/	/	
One-mindfully:			/	/	
			/	/	
Effectively:			/	/	
			/	/	

List any and all wise things you did this week: _____

Note. Adapted from an unpublished worksheet by Seth Axelrod, with his permission.

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MINDFULNESS WORKSHEET 2C

(Mindfulness Handouts 2–5c) (p. 1 of 2)

Mindfulness Core Skills Calendar

Due Date: _____ Name: _____ Week Starting: _____

Check off skills to practice this week:

____ Wise Mind ____ Observing ____ Describing ____ Participating ____ Nonjudgmentally ____ One-mindfully ____ Effectively

While you are practicing skills, stay as aware and mindful as you can. Write it down later.

Name(s) of skill(s)	How did you practice the skill?	Describe your experience, including body sensations, emotions, and thoughts while practicing the skill	What is your experience now, after using the skill?
Example: <i>Participating</i>	<i>I went to a party and joined in conversations with other people.</i>	<i>I felt a tight knot in my stomach, shallow breathing, dry mouth, anxiety that other people would not like me; later I enjoyed the conversation, smiled, noticed other people around me, and ended up having a good time.</i>	<i>I feel amazed that I managed to do this and felt good about myself. I am thinking I may be able to do this again.</i>
Monday:			
Tuesday:			
Wednesday:			

(continued on next page)

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MINDFULNESS WORKSHEET 2C

(p. 2 of 2)

Name(s) of skill(s)	How did you practice the skill?	Describe your experience, including body sensations, emotions, and thoughts while practicing the skill	What is your experience now, after using the skill?
Thursday:			
Friday:			
Saturday:			
Sunday:			

List any and all wise things you did this week: _____

Wise Mind Practice

Due Date: _____ Name: _____ Week Starting: _____

Wise Mind Practice Exercise: Check off an exercise each time you do one.

- ☐☐☐☐ 1. Attended to my breath coming in and out, letting my attention settle into my center.
- ☐☐☐☐ 2. Imagined being a flake of stone on the lake.
- ☐☐☐☐ 3. Imagined walking down an inner spiral stairs.
- ☐☐☐☐ 4. Dropped into the pauses between inhaling and exhaling.
- ☐☐☐☐ 5. Breathed “wise” in, “mind” out.
- ☐☐☐☐ 6. Asked Wise Mind a question (breathing in) and listened for the answer (breathing out).
- ☐☐☐☐ 7. Asked myself, “Is this Wise Mind?”
- ☐☐☐☐ 8. Other (describe): _____
- ☐☐☐☐ 9. Other (describe): _____

Describe the situation and how you practiced Wise Mind:

How effective was the practice in helping you become centered in your Wise Mind?

*Not effective:
I couldn't do the skill
for even 1 minute. I got
distracted or quit.*

1

2

*Somewhat effective:
I was able to practice Wise Mind
and became somewhat centered
in my Wise Mind.*

3

4

*Very effective:
I became centered in Wise
Mind, and was free to do
what needed to be done.*

5

Describe the situation and how you practiced Wise Mind:

How effective was the practice in helping you become centered in your Wise Mind?

*Not effective:
I couldn't do the skill
for even 1 minute. I got
distracted or quit.*

1

2

*Somewhat effective:
I was able to practice Wise Mind
and became somewhat centered
in my Wise Mind.*

3

4

*Very effective:
I became centered in Wise
Mind, and was free to do
what needed to be done.*

5

List any and all wise things you did this week: _____